

Tone reflection

Name the tone gently, then check the read.

Core move

Reflect the emotional colour of the message, then check it. "I might be hearing [tone] around [topic]. Is that close?"

Perception -> Move -> Phrase

Notice flatness, caution, relief, hesitation, pride, strain, or guardedness. Name it softly and attach it to the topic, not the person.

Calibration -> Recovery -> Chain

If they relax or correct you, follow their wording. If you miss, say: "I over-read that. What word fits better?" Then chain to listening, meaning reflection, or action.

Safety line

Use tone words like sticky notes, not label makers. Tentative, correctable, and respectful.